

whether your baby is growing at a usual rate. If you are losing weight while exercising during the pregnancy, you may need to increase the number of calories you eat.

- **Doing abdominal exercises will harm the baby.** You can perform exercises to strengthen your core but try to avoid laying flat on your back in the second and third trimesters. The risk of lying on your back is that your uterus and the weight of the baby can put pressure on the vena cava (the large blood vessel that returns blood to your heart), cause your blood pressure to drop, and can compromise oxygen flow to the baby. If you feel dizzy, roll on to your left side, and symptoms should disappear. Always consult your doctor if you're concerned. See for safe [abdominal exercises](#) after the first trimester.

